

**Pomerantz Career Center**

100 Pomerantz Center, Suite C310
Iowa City, Iowa 52242-7700
319-335-1023 Fax 319-335-1029
www.careers.uiowa.edu

Nomination Information:

Student Name: Ashton Jett Stoelk
Student Email Address: ashton-stoelk@uiowa.edu

Supervisor Name: Lauren Dorzinski
Supervisor Email: lauren-dorzinski@uiowa.edu

Student Position Title: Student Food Service Worker
Department Where Student Position is Held: Food & Nutrition Services
Employment Category (Administrative Support, Student Campus Services, or Science, Health & Engineering):
Student Campus Services (UIHC)

Nomination Criteria:

- ❖ Briefly describe why you are submitting this student for recognition:

I would like to nominate Ashton Stoelk for the Student Employee of the Year to adequately recognize the outstanding hard work he has completed for the Food & Nutrition Services department at the University of Iowa Hospitals & Clinics this past year. Ashton has worked in our hospital retail cafeterias since September of 2020 and is one of my most seasoned student employees.

- ❖ Briefly outline your student employee's accomplishments over this past year and/or how they have contributed to the workplace:

During the past year, Ashton has taken on responsibilities that I have never previously entrusted student employees with handling. Examples include taking shifts located at our remote, off-site, cafeteria locations, one of which is run without a supervisor on staff requiring a great deal of independence and responsibility. Ashton has also stepped up to provide training support for many of our new student employees and budgeted team members. He can do this successfully due to his drive to learn and jump in at any workstation, whether that's cooking, serving, or cashiering. Jett is a calm, efficient, and multi-faceted student employee that every cafeteria and team member enjoys working with.

Ashton has also had a positive impact on our patients and visitors. One example from this past year that exhibited how Ashton will go above and beyond to serve our customers involved a patient's mother. Ashton was working in the Stead Family Children's Hospital Café one morning when a woman came up

to the station to order, asking if we had blueberry pancakes available. Since this is not something we currently offer on our menu, Ashton explained to the women that we did not have blueberry pancakes but shared what offerings we did have that morning. The women politely declined the other options, sharing that her child was a patient upstairs in the Children's Hospital, that he was not eating well, and that he had surprisingly requested blueberry pancakes this morning. Ashton could have easily apologized and let the women continue her day without these pancakes, but that's not the type of person Ashton is. He sprung into action, asking the women if she could wait while he explored options to make her son's blueberry pancake dream come true. After touching base with his manager, Ashton located a mixed berry product that contained blueberries he could sift out and use and pancake mix in the storage room that he quickly whipped up. The women was thrilled, hopeful that her sick child would finally eat a good meal upon her return. While this may seem like a small gesture, it's a very meaningful one and exemplifies the character that Ashton shows through his work.

- ❖ How does this student exhibit NACE (National Association of Colleges & Employers) competencies in their position? (See attached outline). Please provide specific examples:

Career & Self-Development

Ashton has always been self-motivated to learn the various aspects and job duties in our department. Many students will only learn the basic tasks of serving and cooking, but Ashton has taken steps further, learning our cash register system and working with our vending cashier team to help complete money handling and depositing tasks, which are above and beyond tasks for a student team member.

Equity & Inclusion

Ashton is scheduled each week to work in one or multiple locations each week, in total seven different locations, all with different team members. The staff that make up Food & Nutrition Services is quite diverse, but Ashton works cohesively with everyone. Ashton greets and assists all our customers the same as well, regardless of their appearance or title.

Communication, Professionalism, & Teamwork

I can always trust that Ashton will show up for his shifts, ready to help the team. Ashton has a full plate outside of work, which is stress that commonly leaks into work performance for many other students, but Ashton always maintains his composure and professionalism at work. If a scheduling conflict comes up on Ashton's schedule, he is one to reach out to his fellow student co-workers to find someone to cover his shift instead of leaving that burden on his manager.

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❖ Closing statement:

I hope that these examples paint a picture of what an outstanding student employee Ashton Stoelk is and continues to be for our Food & Nutrition Services department. I know that I can rely on Ashton to continue to show up for his team, produce great results, and put a smile on his co-workers' faces until graduation. I'm honored to have the opportunity to nominate Ashton for this award and appreciate your consideration.

Virtual Signature of person submitting: Lauren Dorzinski